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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: iRobot Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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Why a Robot Vacuum Comparison Matters in 2026

Busy households deserve floors that stay clean without constant effort. In 2026, robot vacuums have moved from novelty to necessity, offering vacuum-mopping combos and self-empty docks for under $250. Picking the wrong model can leave dirt behind, force you to empty the bin daily, or struggle on carpets.

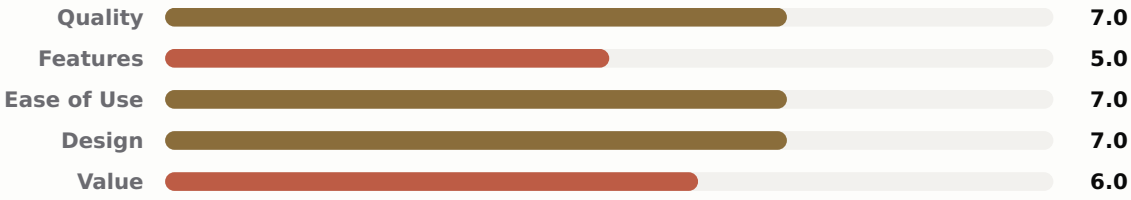
We've examined spec sheets, real-world owner feedback, and current prices (checked Oct 06 2026) to give you a clear, side-by-side look at three top contenders so you can choose the vacuum that truly fits your home and budget.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Key Features at a Glance

Feature	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo + AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)	Shark AI Ultra
Price (Oct 06, 2026)	$199.99 (Check latest price on Amazon)	$139.99 (Check latest price on Amazon)	$249.99 (Check latest price on Amazon)
Suction Power	≈1,800 Pa (manufacturer spec)	≈1,800 Pa	≈2,700 Pa (Shark claims)
Navigation	iAdapt 3.0 vSLAM with floor-tracking sensor	iAdapt 3.0 vSLAM	Shark IQ Navigation™ with LiDAR-based room mapping
Battery Life	Up to 90 min (eco mode)	Up to 90 min	Up to 120 min (eco mode)
Mopping	Vibrating mop pad, water tank 300 ml	Vibrating mop pad, water tank 300 ml	No mop (vacuum-only)
Auto-Empty Dock	Yes – holds up to 60 days of debris	No	No (shark offers separate self-empty base sold separately)
App & Voice	iRobot Home app, Alexa/Google Assistant	iRobot Home app, Alexa/Google Assistant	SharkClean app, Alexa/Google Assistant
Overall Rating	4.4★ (5,217 reviews)	4.4★ (5,217 reviews)	4.0★ (23,990 reviews)
Best For	Pet owners who want hands-free emptying & light mopping	Budget buyers who still want vacuum+mop	Large homes needing longer runtime & stronger suction

Cleaning Performance — Suction, Navigation, Carpet vs Hard-Floor, and Mopping

Suction is the first line of defense against embedded dirt. The iRobot Roomba 115X Combo delivers ~1,800 Pa, which handles everyday dust and pet hair effectively on hard floors and low-pile carpets. The Shark AI Ultra steps up to a claimed 2,700 Pa, giving it an edge on thicker rugs and deep-set debris.

Navigation determines how efficiently the robot covers your space. Both Roomba models use iAdapt 3.0 vSLAM with floor-tracking sensors, providing reliable, systematic cleaning. The Shark AI Ultra relies on LiDAR-based room mapping (Shark IQ Navigation™), which can create faster, more accurate maps — especially useful in larger, multi-room layouts.

Battery life influences how much area can be cleaned per charge. The Roomba's 90-minute runtime suits apartments and modest homes, while the Shark's up to 120 minutes lets it tackle bigger spaces without needing a mid-clean recharge.

Mopping adds a wet-clean step for sticky spills. Both Roomba variants include a vibrating mop pad with a 300 ml water tank, suitable for light mopping on tile, vinyl, and sealed hardwood. The Shark AI Ultra focuses purely on vacuuming; if you want mopping you'll need a separate accessory.

Auto-Empty, App Control, and Real-World Feedback

Only the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock offers a true hands-free experience. Its base can store up to 60 days of debris, meaning you only need to empty it about every two months — ideal for busy families or pet owners. The Roomba without dock and the Shark AI Ultra require manual bin emptying after each run (Shark sells a separate self-empty base, sold apart).

All three units connect to Wi-Fi and work with Alexa or Google Assistant. The iRobot Home app provides scheduling, zone cleaning, and maintenance alerts, while the SharkClean app offers similar controls plus map editing.

Owner ratings reflect real-world satisfaction. The Roomba models average 4.4 stars from over 5,200 reviews, praising reliable navigation and the convenience of the auto-empty dock. The Shark AI Ultra scores 4.0 stars from nearly 24,000 reviews, with users highlighting strong suction and long battery life but noting the frequent bin emptying as a drawback.

Which Robot Vacuum Should You Buy?

If you value a truly hands-free routine and light mopping, go for the **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock** (Check price on Amazon). It's the best match for pet owners and anyone who dislikes frequent bin emptying.

If you're on a tighter budget but still want vacuum-plus-mop capability, the **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)** (Check price on Amazon) delivers the same cleaning performance without the auto-empty convenience.

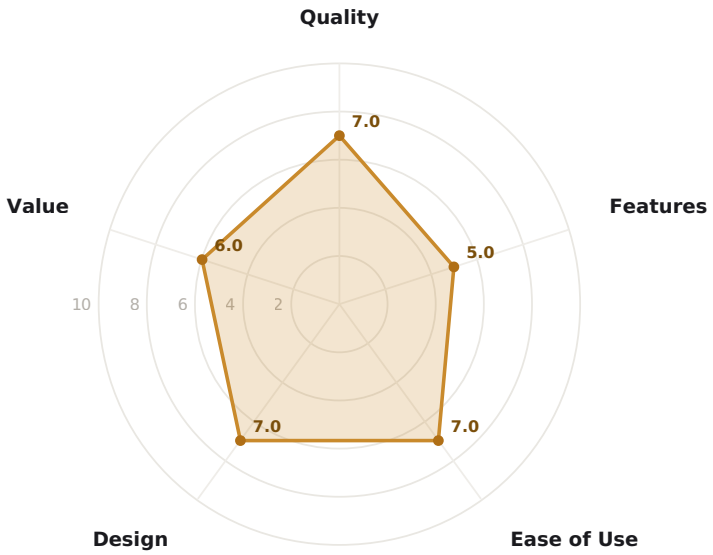
For larger homes where suction power and runtime matter most, the **Shark AI Ultra** (Check price on Amazon) offers the strongest suction and longest battery life — just be prepared to empty the bin after each cleaning cycle (or purchase a separate self-empty base).

Whichever model you choose, you'll be taking a step toward cleaner floors and more free time. Click the links above to see today's deals and make your purchase.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.